

SSA Starter Kit

Steps to Guide Your Application

This starter kit walks you through the main steps used to guide an SSA application. Use it to prepare your answers before you begin, and keep it nearby while you complete the application.

STEPS TO GUIDE YOUR APPLICATION

Step 1. Create your ID.me account — this is how you prove your identity online.

Step 2. Link it to your **my Social Security** account at ssa.gov.

Step 3. Make sure you can log in successfully before you start the application.

When you apply online, Social Security will ask about the following. Go through each area and prepare your answers before you begin.

1. Identity Verification

- Full legal name, date of birth, and the last 4 of the Social Security number
- Phone number, address, and email
- Preferred contact method
- Emergency contact
- Whether the client has guardianship or a representative payee in place

2. Basic Eligibility Screening

- Are you currently working? If yes — how much do you earn monthly?
- When was your last day worked? What job did you last perform?
- Have you applied for SSDI/SSI before?
- Are you receiving unemployment? Workers' comp?

3. Medical Conditions — for each condition:

- What conditions prevent you from working?
- When were you diagnosed, and who diagnosed you?
- How does this condition limit you day to day?
- Any hospitalizations? Any surgeries?
- Any mental health diagnoses?

4. Medical Providers — for each provider:

- Provider name, clinic/hospital name, address, and phone number
- Type of doctor
- Last appointment and next appointment
- Note: use separate paper — add ALL providers that are being seen by the client.

5. Medications — for each medication:

- Name, dosage, and frequency
- Prescribing doctor
- Side effects
- Note: use separate paper for the full medication list.

6. Functional Limitations

- How long can you sit? How long can you stand? How far can you walk? How much can you lift?
- Do you need help with bathing, dressing, cooking, or cleaning?
- Do you use a cane, walker, or wheelchair?
- Do you have memory or concentration problems? Panic attacks or anxiety?
- How many bad days per week?

7. Daily Living Activities

- Do you drive? Cook? Clean? Shop? Manage money?
- Do you need reminders to take medication?
- Do you care for children or pets?

8. Work History — Last 15 Years — for each job:

- Job title, employer, and dates worked
- Hours per week and pay rate
- Physical duties
- Why you stopped working
- Note: use separate paper for the full work history.

9. Education & Training

- Highest grade completed
- GED?
- Special education or IEP?
- Vocational training? Certifications?

10. Financial & Living Situation

- Do you live alone or with family?
- Do you pay rent or mortgage?
- Do you receive food stamps? Child support?
- Do you have savings? Health insurance?

11. Prior SSA Activity

- Have you applied before? Were you denied?
- Do you have a my Social Security account?
- Have you had a consultative exam before?

PLEASE READ — IMPORTANT INFORMATION

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